Why now?

Each of my three concerns about Friends is setting records at the same time. Each record is shown here as its own small clay model, so you can look at one idea at a time.

Jeff Kisling, member of Bear Creek Meeting, Iowa Yearly Meeting (Conservative)

Why it cannot wait

Every concern at once.

Hunger, wealth at the top, homelessness and detention are all at or near records together, and they feed each other.

13.7%
Households without secure food
Highest since 2014

32.5%
Top 1% share of household wealth
Record

770,000+
People homeless on one night
Record

≈3 years
Carbon budget left for 1.5°C
Window closing

≈73,000
People in ICE detention
Record

The measuring is being taken away.

USDA ended its food security report after the 2024 numbers. What is no longer counted is easier to ignore.

The last reading: **13.7%** of U.S. households without secure food, the highest since 2014. There will be no reading for 2025.

The window is closing.

At the 2024 rate, the carbon budget for 1.5°C runs out about three years from the start of 2025.

About 130 billion tonnes of CO_2 remained at the start of 2025. At the 2024 rate, about **60%** of that time has already passed today (an estimate, not a measurement).

Channels take years to build.

The moment they are needed is not the moment to begin.

Every relationship behind this work took years: three years of Saturday mornings at Des Moines Mutual Aid, eight years since the 2018 march, thirty years of Bear Creek Friends at Prairie Awakening. A channel begun today will not be ready until near the end of this decade.



Three concerns, one moment

Each hill is a concern. Its channel carries the records that belong to it down into the same pool: now. Where two channels join, a record belongs to both concerns. The small figures at the edge are us, looking in.

The three concerns and their queries, then each record's own model, follow below.

CONCERN 1

The poverty around us

Food sits in the store while people starve outside it.

Do we recognize the difference between charity and mutual aid? Do we understand how it shows the fundamental differences in hierarchy and power each represents?

CONCERN 2

Who gets to be free

A legal and economic order built to keep it that way.

We know there are millions suffering an economic draft: from student debt, from needing a job because of its health benefits, or from a lack of economic opportunity that leads to the armed forces.

CONCERN 3

The violence holding it up

Police, prisons, borders, deportations.

The scenes of armed repression and deportation are horrifying to watch. We know where this is likely to go. How can we say we are a peaceful people if we simply watch?



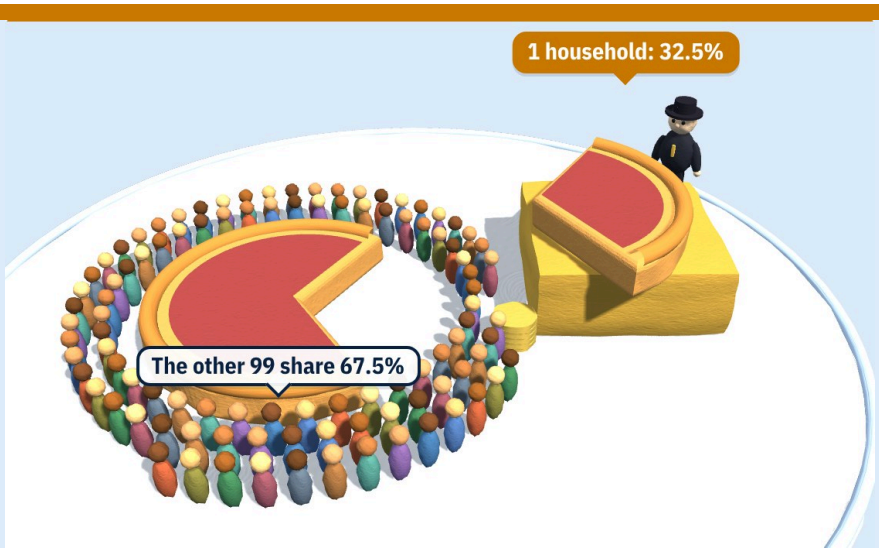
1 · POVERTY

13.7% Households without secure food · 2024

A grocery with full shelves and a locked, priced door. Of the eight homes beside it, one family sits at a table with empty bowls: 13.7% is a little more than one home in eight. The clipboard is the report that counted them. It has been ended.

Highest since 2014

USDA Economic Research Service, via RFD-TV



1 · POVERTY 2 · FREEDOM

32.5% Top 1% share of household wealth · Q2 2026

The pie is all U.S. household wealth. One household in a hundred stands on a gold pedestal beside its slice: 32.5% of the pie. The other 99 crowd around what is left. All 100 figures are in the model. In 1990 the top slice was 22.4%.

Record

Federal Reserve Distributional Financial Accounts, via FRED



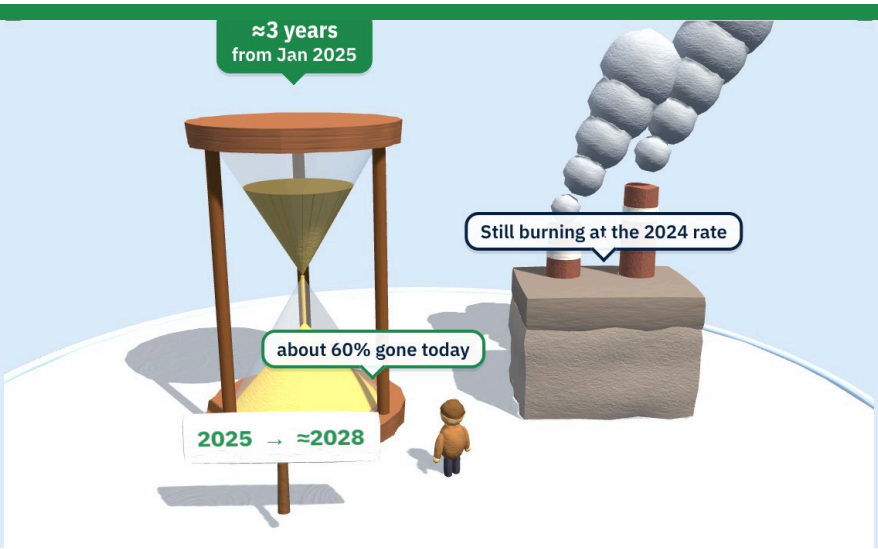
1 · POVERTY 2 · FREEDOM

770,000+ People homeless on one night · Jan 2024

Apartment buildings with lights on and a For Rent sign, and people sleeping in tents and on a bench in front of them. One January night counted more than 770,000 people without a home, up 18% in one year.

Record

HUD report, via Connecticut Public



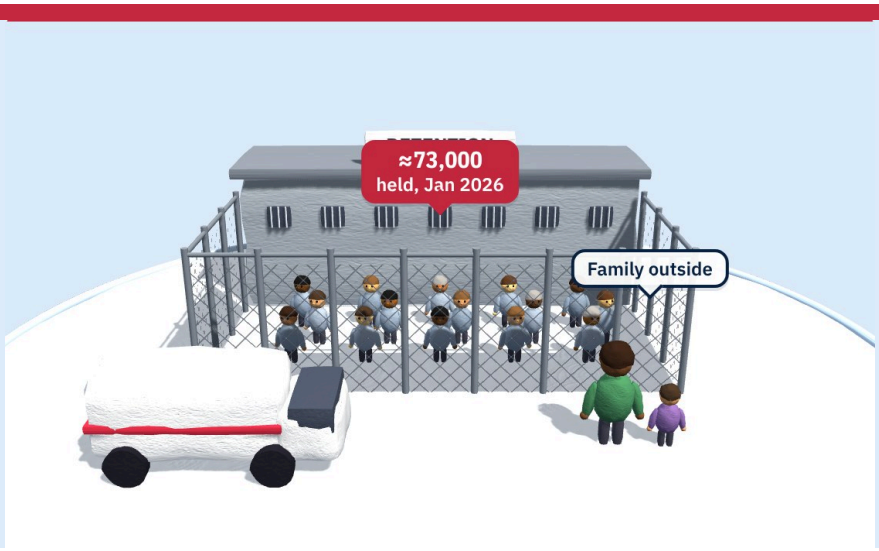
2 · FREEDOM

≈3 years Carbon budget left for 1.5°C · from the start of 2025

An hourglass for the carbon budget left to keep warming near 1.5°C: about 130 billion tonnes at the start of 2025, roughly three years at the 2024 rate, while the stacks keep smoking. The fallen sand shows about 60% of that time already gone today. That part is an estimate, not a measurement.

Window closing

Indicators of Global Climate Change 2024, University of Leeds



3 · VIOLENCE 2 · FREEDOM

≈73,000 **People in ICE detention** · Jan 2026

A fenced detention building with people held inside the wire and a family waiting outside it. About 73,000 people were held in January 2026, up 84% from just under 40,000 a year earlier.

Record

CBS News, from internal DHS data

From *Three Concerns About Friends* and *Channels Into Knowledge*, by Jeff Kisling, member of Bear Creek Meeting, Iowa Yearly Meeting (Conservative). Speaks for no meeting or organization.

- Households without secure food: USDA Economic Research Service, via RFD-TV
- Top 1% share of household wealth: Federal Reserve Distributional Financial Accounts, via FRED
- People homeless on one night: HUD report, via Connecticut Public
- Carbon budget left for 1.5°C: Indicators of Global Climate Change 2024, University of Leeds
- People in ICE detention: CBS News, from internal DHS data
- The hourglass and today's fallen sand are estimates at the 2024 emissions rate, not measurements. The models are illustrations; only the numbers come from the sources.